

CHAPTER 2**THE PHYSICAL REGIONS OF PAKISTAN AND THE WORLD****Learning Outcomes**

After studying this chapter the students will be able to:

1. Define the term “Regions” and give examples.
2. Identify the key physical regions of Pakistan.
3. Describe the distinctive characteristics /features of each physical region of Pakistan.
4. Locate physical regions sharing similar characteristics on a world map.
5. Compare the life of the people living in different physical regions of Pakistan with people living in similar regions in other countries.
6. Locate, interpret and present information in the form of a tourist guide book of the country of their choice.
7. Define the term Interdependence.
8. Identify the variety of ways in which people are interdependent.
9. Describe the ways the people of Pakistan are interdependent.
10. Explain various ways in which the countries of the world are dependent.

THE PHYSICAL REGIONS OF PAKISTAN AND THE WORLD REGIONS

Just as our faces have features such as eyes and ears, every place or environment has features. There are two types of features – natural and cultural. A region is an area that has one or more common natural or cultural features or characteristics. Regions that share a common physical feature are called physical regions. For example, the equatorial region is a natural region that is situated between 5° N and 5° S of the Equator. This region shares a similar climate. In the same way all areas that have high lands are called mountainous regions. Regions that share a cultural feature, for example, language or political system are called cultural regions. For example, in East Africa English is commonly spoken, whereas in West Africa French is spoken. East Africa is called an English speaking region, whereas West Africa is called a French speaking region.

Activity

- a. Define the term 'Regions' and give an example of a different physical region and a different cultural region from the ones given above.
- b. Draw a picture with at least 2 natural features. Show it to a classmate and have him/her identify the features.

Major Physical Regions of Pakistan

Look at the physical map of Pakistan given below. On the basis of its physical features, Pakistan can be divided into the following regions:

1. The Mountainous Region
2. The Plateaus
3. The Indus Plains
4. The Coastal Region
5. The Desert Region

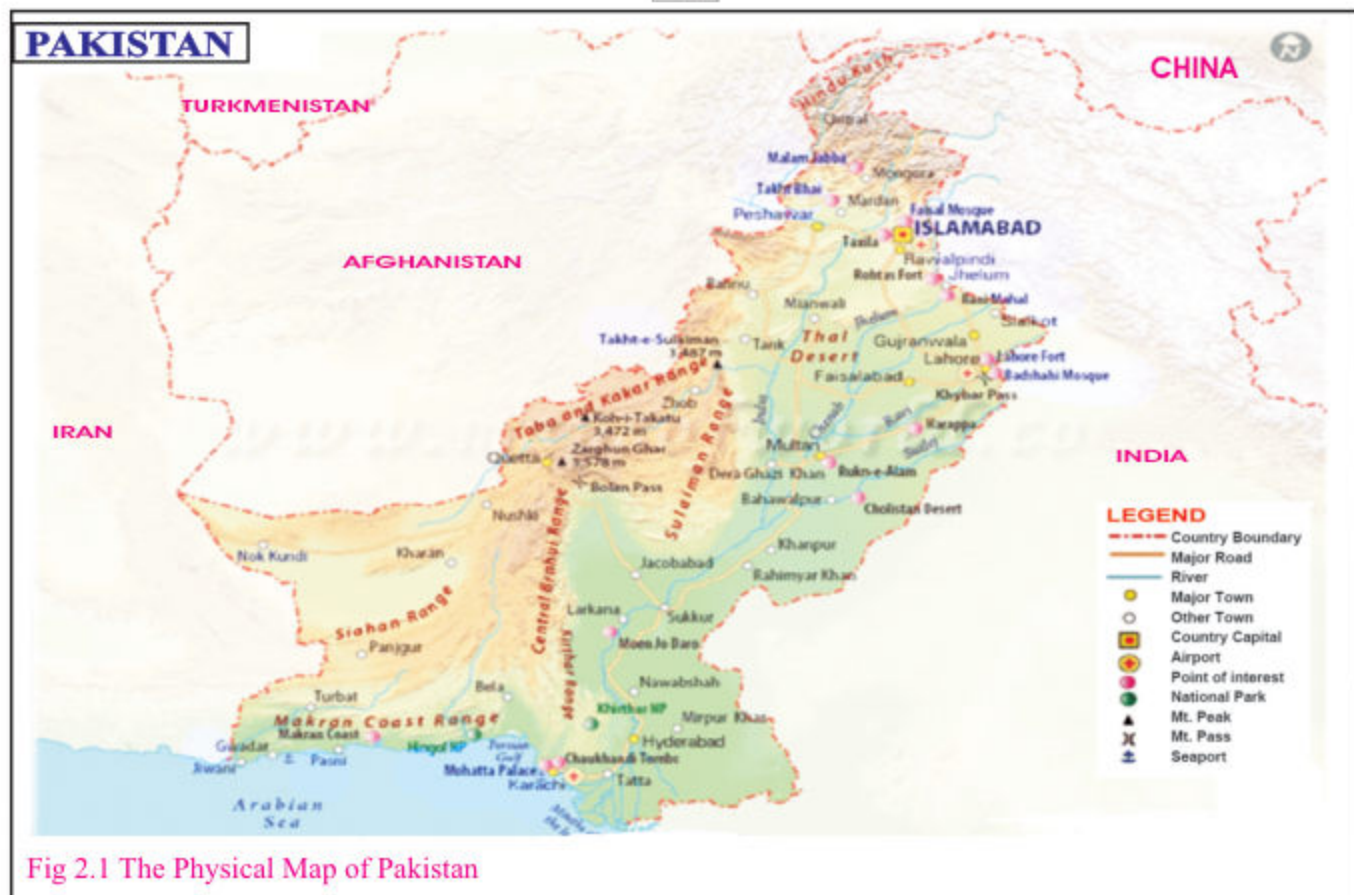


Fig 2.1 The Physical Map of Pakistan

1. The Mountainous Region

There are many mountains in the north, northeast and northwest of Pakistan. This region is made up of three mountain ranges: the Himalayas, the Karakoram and the Hindukush. To the south of the Hindukush lie the Koh-e-Safed range and the Sulaiman range. Between the mountains are deep river valleys.



The Mountainous Region of Pakistan

Teacher's Note

Get or make a large map of Pakistan. Cover it with plastic. When teaching about the physical features of Pakistan, ask students to fill in the areas on top of the plastic so that the map can be cleaned and used again.

The Himalayas

The Himalayas are in the northeast. They can be divided into three ranges on the basis of their height.

- ❖ **The Sub-Himalayas**
 - southern range of the Himalayas
 - located in the district of Rawalpindi
 - height of about 600 to 1200 metres above sea level
- ❖ **The Lesser Himalayas**
 - between sub and greater Himalayas
 - located north of Rawalpindi
 - height of about 1800 to 4600 metres above sea level
- ❖ **The Great Himalayas**
 - located in district Kohistan
 - covered with snow throughout the year
 - height of about 6500 meters above sea level

Because of the cool climate in the lesser Himalayas people have developed places like Murree, Nathiagali and Ghoragali into hill stations. Both Pakistanis and tourists come here to enjoy the cool weather and natural beauty.



Cool weather and natural beauty of the Lesser Himalayas

The Karakoram Mountains

The Karakoram Mountains lie in the North of Kashmir and in the Gilgit-Baltistan area. The mountains in this range are very high. K-2 the second highest mountain in the world, is part of this range. Mountain peaks like the K-2 remain covered in snow throughout the year. Because the Karakoram mountains are very high it is difficult to cross them. Therefore, a few passes (passages) have been made through the mountains. The Karakoram Highway, the highest road in the world has been built for the transportation of goods and people between Pakistan and China. Most of the people live in the fertile valleys of Hunza and Gilgit.



K-2, the second highest peak in the Karakoram Mountains

The Hindukush Mountains

The Hindukush mountains lie in the north-west of Pakistan. These mountains form a border between Pakistan and Afghanistan. The highest peak in the range Tirich Mir is located in Chitral, Pakistan. Like the Karakoram mountains, the mountain peaks of the Hindukush Mountains are also covered with snow throughout the year and have little vegetation on them. A few rivers such as the Kabul and Swat flow down from these mountains. People live in the valleys of Swat and Chitral that are located in these mountains.

Other Mountains and Hills

To the South of the Hindukush mountains lie the Koh-e-Safed range and the Waziristan Hills. These mountains form a border between Pakistan and Afghanistan. The most famous pass here is the Khyber Pass which links Pakistan with Afghanistan. Here, people irrigate the land to grow wheat, rice, sugar-cane and tobacco.

Further South between the Indus Plain and the Balochistan Plateau lie the Sulaiman Mountains and the Khirthar Hills. The mineral limestone, found in this area, is used to make cement.

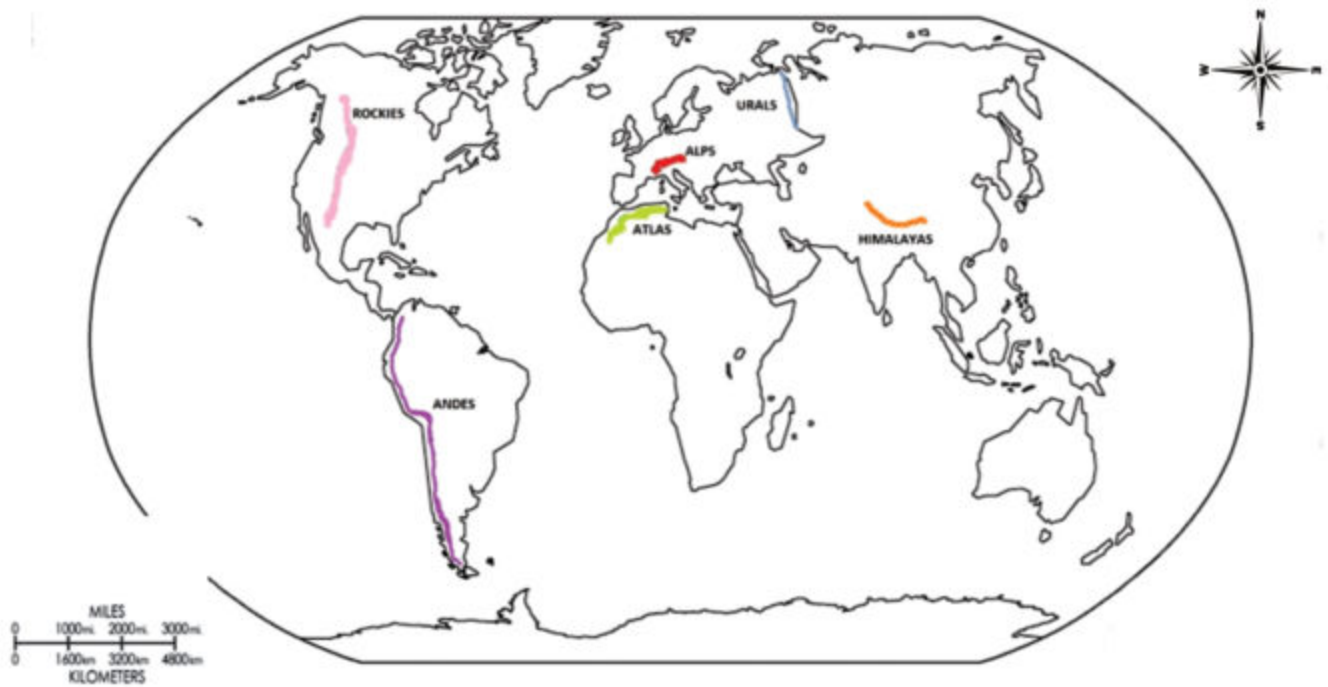


Fig 2.2 World map showing the main mountain ranges

Activity

- Name the mountainous regions of the world, identify the countries they lie in.
- Describe three distinctive features of mountainous regions.

2. The Plateaus

High land which is flat at the top is called a plateau or tableland. There are two plateaus in Pakistan: the Potwar Plateau and the Balochistan Plateau.

The Potwar Plateau

The Potwar plateau is located between the Indus and Jhelum rivers. It is 300 to 600 metres high. This area has little rainfall. Therefore, it is not suitable for agriculture. Minerals such as oil, natural gas, marble and limestone are found here. Many cities like Rawalpindi and Islamabad have developed here.

The Balochistan Plateau

The Balochistan Plateau is located to the West of the Suleiman Mountains and Khirthar Hills. It is 600 to 900 metres high. The area gets very little rainfall throughout the year. The shortage of water and the rocky surface make it unfit for agriculture. In some areas where water is available, crops are grown using an underground irrigation system called Karez. Minerals such as coal, Gas, copper and marble are found here.



Cattle rearing in the Baluchistan Plateau

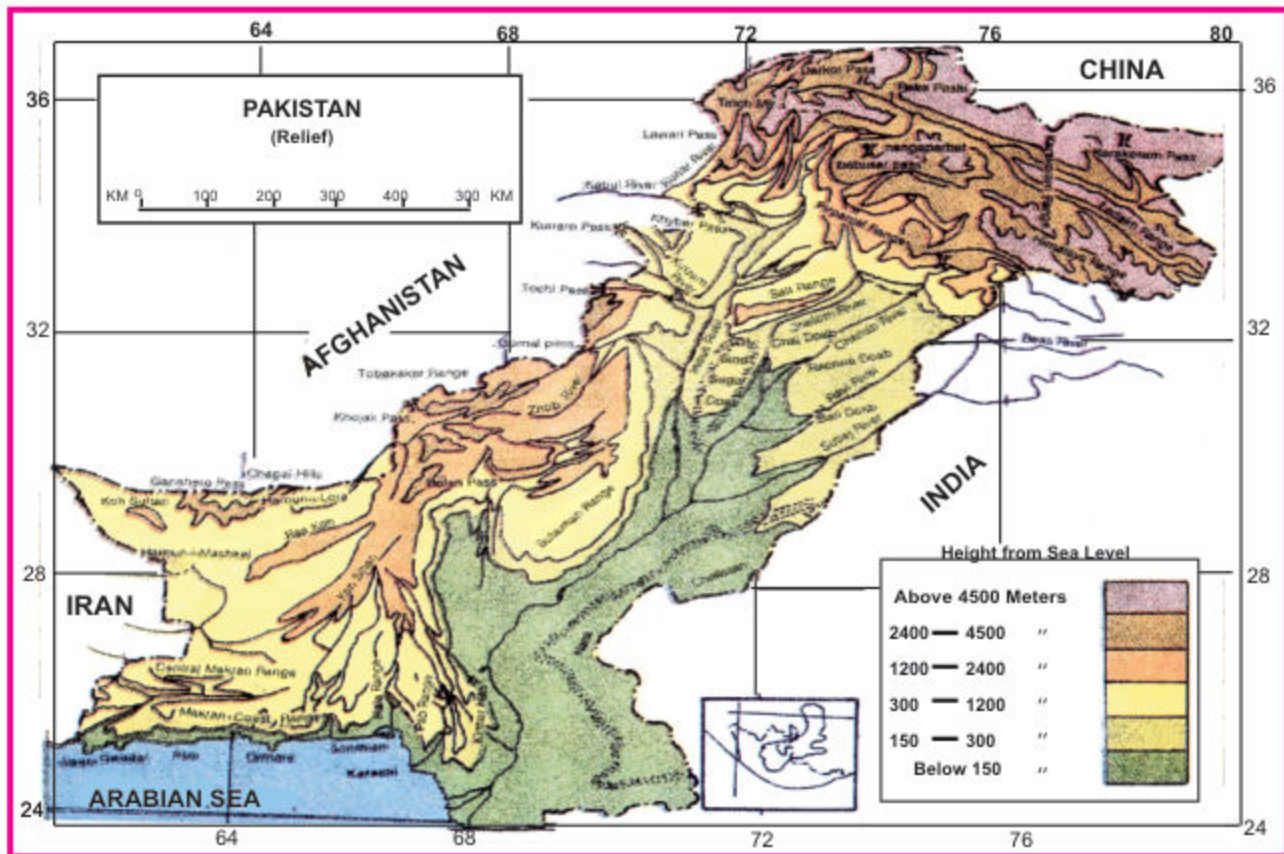


Fig 2.3 Relief Map of Pakistan

Activity

- Name three plateaus in other parts of the world.
- Describe the distinctive features of the plateaus.

3. The Indus Plains



Fields in the Indus plains

The River Indus is about 2700 kilometres long. It starts in the Himalaya Mountains situated in Tibet and enters Pakistan near Gilgit. When it enters Pakistan, the Indus is narrow, less than half a kilometer wide, but it is

fast flowing. As it flows it is joined by many other rivers and streams. The sediment deposited by the River Indus and its tributaries have caused the formation of the Indus Plains. The Indus Plains can be divided into three parts: the Upper Indus Plain, the Lower Indus Plain and the Indus Deltaic Plain.

The Upper Indus Plain is the area where the Sutlej, Ravi, Chenab and Jhelum flow. The area between two rivers is called “doab” and is a very fertile area.

At Mithankot the River Indus is joined by its eastern tributaries. Beyond Mithankot the River Indus flows alone. The area through which the River Indus flows alone is known as the Lower Indus Plain.



Lower Indus Plain

The Indus Deltaic Plain is formed where the River Indus flows into the Arabian Sea. Due to the mixing of the sweet water of the Indus with the salt water of the Arabian Sea this area have large mangrove forests

The largest canal system of the world has been dug in the Indus Plains. The network of canals provides farmers in the Punjab and Sindh provinces with plenty of water for agriculture. Farmers grow wheat, cotton, sugarcane, rice and many fruits and vegetables in this area. Industries have also been set up here. Due to the availability of jobs and the presence of a suitable climate most of the people of Pakistan live in the Indus Plains.

Activity

- Name five plains in other parts of the world.
- Identify three similarities between Plains of Pakistan and the plains you have named.

4. The Coastal Region

The coastal area of Pakistan stretches from Balochistan to Shah Bander in Sindh. It is nearly 1050 kilometers long. Karachi is situated along the coastline. It is a natural water channel and has been made into a seaport. Other sea ports such as Bin Qasim and Gwadar have been developed along the coast. The seaports have been developed for trade with other countries. They play an important role in the economic development of the country. Because of the sea along the coast many people engage in fishing. Some of the fish is eaten within Pakistan and the rest is exported to other countries.



Gwadar Port



Port Qasim

Activity

- Name 5 major seaports of the world.
- Describe the distinctive features of the Coastal Region of Pakistan.

5. The Desert Region

A hot desert is an area of land that is very dry because it receives with very little vegetation due to the little rainfall. Here temperatures are extreme. Pakistan has three large deserts; Thar-Cholistani, Thal, and Chaghi-Kharan.

- The **Thar-Cholistani Desert** lies in the eastern parts of the Punjab and Sindh Provinces. Here, herding is the common occupation of the people.
- The **Thal Desert**, lies between Indus and Jhelum rivers. Here generally un-irrigated agriculture is practiced.
- The **Chaghi-Kharan Desert** that lies in the western parts of Balochistan Plateau is the most dry and barren.



The Thar Desert

The deserts are the driest parts of the country because the amount of rainfall here is very low. Most of the area is barren with large sand dunes. Canals have been dug to irrigate some parts of the deserts in order to grow crops.



Derawar Fort in Cholistan Desert



Kharan Desert

Activity

- a. Name two hot and two cold deserts of the world.
- b. Compare hot and cold deserts.

Life in the Different Physical Regions of Pakistan and the World

Life in the Mountains

The mountainous areas of Pakistan are thinly populated. The main occupations include lumbering (cutting of trees), herding, mining and providing services to tourists. The houses built here are simple. Due to the extremely harsh climate and lack of facilities, people living on high mountains migrate to lower lands in winters and return in the summer season.



A Simple House



Lumbering



Mining

The Alps of Europe have almost similar physical characteristics as the Himalayas. The main occupations include tourist services, industries, banking, education and dairy farming. Houses are sophisticated and stylish. Since facilities are available all year round, there is no seasonal migration.



Skiing and mountain climbing in Europe

Life in Plains

The plains of Pakistan are very fertile, because there is mineral-rich soil and plenty of water. In rural areas, agriculture is the main occupation, whereas in urban areas, people commonly work in factories and industries, and provides services such as education, health, and security. Since job opportunities are better in the urban areas, people from the rural areas migrate here. The population of the urban areas is therefore, increasing rapidly.



Farming done by hand



Animals kept on a farm



A Cement Factory

The plains of USA are also fertile. Agriculture is well developed. Most of the farming is done by machines, therefore, the number of people engaged in agricultural are much fewer as compared to Pakistan. Job opportunities and life amenities are equally good in the plain areas as in other parts of the country. Technology and means of transportation are very well developed as well.



Farming done by machine



Farm animals



A network of roads

Life in Deserts

The deserts of Pakistan are thinly populated. Because of the dry climate, agriculture is almost non-existent in most of the desert lands. Herding is the main occupation. Due to the lack of facilities people live in simple homes, are less educated and use camels for transportation.



Herding Cattle



Women bringing water from a distance



People travelling on camels

The desert of Arabia is also thinly populated. The people are wealthy because of the rich oil reserves. The road network is very well-developed and settlements are found at regular intervals. Camels were the common mode of transportation but now vehicles are also used.



Life in Coastal Areas

Pakistan has a long coastal belt. Fishing, boat-making and ship-making are the main industries in this region. Karachi, which is Pakistan's largest city, is located in this area. Being a port city and a center of international trade and industry, employment opportunities are better here than in other parts of the region. This region has great potential for development.



Fishing and boat making in coastal areas of Pakistan

The countries of East-Asia such as Malaysia and Indonesia also have large coastal areas. Industry, tourism and recreation services are very well-developed here. Because of the warm weather and beautiful beaches many tourists visit these countries providing them with a good source of income. Due to this, these countries are well developed and prosperous.



The countries of East Asia are well developed and prosperous

Interdependence

Interdependence is the reliance or dependence of people in one area for food, goods, resources, technology and knowledge from people in other areas. This interaction benefits the people of both areas.



Trucks used to transport goods from one place to other place

Train used to transport goods from one place to other place

Interdependence within Pakistan

Pakistan is a vast and diverse country. The physical features and climate are very different across its land. As a result, different kinds of resources are found in different parts of Pakistan. For example, in Punjab and Sindh the land and climate is good for agriculture, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan provinces have abundant mineral resources, while Gilgit-Baltistan has thick forests. Because of the variety of resources among these regions there are interdependent. For example, there is trade of different goods within the country. Food grains such as wheat, rice and maize are transported from Punjab and Sindh to the rest of the country, while mineral products are transported from Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan to Punjab and Sindh. Similarly, the forest products of Gilgit-Baltistan are used in all places in the country.



Forests of Gilgit- Baltistan and Wood Trade

Activity

- Define the term 'Interdependence'.
- List at least three ways in which people are interdependent.

Interdependence in the World

Each country or region in the world possesses different kinds of resources. No one region is self-sufficient in all the requirements of its people.

When goods and services are sold to other countries they are called exports. Similarly, when goods and services are bought from other countries they are called imports.



A container ship, transporting goods across the seas

Exports earn money for a country which can be used by it to buy food, equipment or consumer goods from other countries. Exports of goods and services increases the income of a country and promotes its economic growth and development. For example, Pakistan exports rice, cotton and cotton textiles, leather and leather goods and sports goods. The money earned from exports is used to import heavy engineering machines and tools, trucks, and other capital equipment from the developed countries. Pakistan needs to export more goods and services so as to increase income which it can use for its development.

SUMMARY

In this chapter we have learnt the meaning of the term 'region', the characteristics of each or the physical regions of Pakistan and identified regions in other parts of the world that share similar characteristics. We have also learnt how people live in these regions in Pakistan and compared them with how people in similar regions in other parts of the world live. We have also learnt the many ways in which the people of Pakistan are interdependent on each other as well as the various ways in which countries of the world are interdependent.

EXERCISE

A. Multiple choice questions

1. How many major physical regions does Pakistan have?
a) 1 b) 3 c) 5
2. How many plateaus are there in Pakistan?
a) 1 b) 2 c) 3
3. In which continent are the Atlas mountains located?
a) Africa b) Asia c) Europe
4. What is a common means of travel in hot deserts?
a) Camels b) Donkeys c) Horses
5. What common human feature is shared by Spain, Brazil and Columbia
a) Language b) political system c) System of Government

B. Answer the following questions

1. Define the term region. Name the main physical regions of Pakistan.
2. Define the term interdependence. Describe the ways in which the people of Pakistan are interdependent giving suitable examples.
3. Explain with examples the various ways in which countries of the world are dependent on each other.

C. Complete the table

Fill in the following table to compare the life of the people living in different physical regions of Pakistan with that of people living in similar regions in other countries of the world:

Name of the Physical Region	Physical Features of the Region	Life of People living in the region in Pakistan	Life of People living in the region in one other country of the world
Mountainous			
Plateaus			
Plains			
Coastal			
Desert			

D. Practical work

1. Draw an outline of the map of Pakistan. Using different colours identify the physical regions on it.
2. Choose any country of the world.
 - a. Find out information about the country that you have chosen from different sources-newspapers and magazines, internet, someone in your family, etc.
 - b. Prepare a Tourist Guide Book and present all the information in it.
 - c. Try to make your Tourist Guide Book attractive and interesting by adding pictures (You may draw or cut and paste them) and photographs and interesting facts about the country.
 - d. Display you Tourist Guide Book in the library for other students to read or just share your guide book with your classmates. This exchange of Tourist Guide Books with each other will help you and your classmates to know about more and more countries of the world.

E. Extension activity

After sharing the information with each other the students could be given a quiz based on the information about different countries of the world.

Teacher's Note

For the practical work, students may start by stapling sheets of paper together in the form of a booklet. They should be encouraged to present their work neatly. The cover of the Tourist Guide Book should also be designed in a creative manner.

Students should exchange their Tourist Guide Books to know about other countries of the world which other students have chosen. A quiz based on the information about different countries of the world may follow this activity to assess students' learning from this activity.